

marker *-a-, *-i-, *-o- + aspect/tense marker *-r-, *-n-, + stem + plural marker *-n- (for 1pp and 2pp) + subject marker

Starostin also reconstructs the following system of subject verbal agreement suffixes (Starostin Georgii 1995: 162):

1ps *-ŋ 1pp*-ʒəŋ (Kott -toŋ)
 2ps *-[k]u 2pp *-[k]oŋ
 3psm *-a 3pp *-aŋ
 3psf *-i

On the basis of these reconstructions by Georgii Starostin I believe it is possible to provide the following analysis of the two verbal forms in the Jie poem:

替戾岡 = *thijʔ-re(ts)-kang = *t-i-r-ek-ang “went out”

preverb *t- + *-i- conjugation marker + perfective *-r- + *-ek-, stem + aŋ 3pp

Cf. also stem *-ek- and Proto-Yeniseian *-jaq- “come/go”

勍禿當 = *Ko-thok-tang = *k-o-t-o-kt-ang

preverb *k- + oʔ + object marker *t- + conjugation marker *-o- + *-kt- “to catch” + aŋ 3pp

Morphology seems to fit almost perfectly with Proto-Yeniseian morphology reconstructed by Georgii Starostin. Moreover, at least one of the verbal roots, *-kt- “to catch” can be paralleled by Ket *-kas-* “to take”, “to catch” attested in literature in the following forms: *dkasayus* “he takes him”, *dkasanem* “he took him” (Vall & Kanakin 1990: 51), *dkasanem* “I caught” (Vall & Kanakin 1990: 67). Ralf Stefan Georg also kindly elicited for me numerous forms from his Ket informant, Zoia Maksimova that are all based on the stem *-qos-* “to take”, e.g. *qos'-abət* “I take (all the time).” It was mentioned earlier that Xiong-nu, like Pumpokol, has *-t-* corresponding to sibilants in other Yeniseian languages, so we should expect something like **-kat-* in Xiong-nu. Less obvious, but still possible, is the equation of the stem of the first verb **-ek-* “to go out” with the Ket stem *-(y)aq-* “id”, cf. *diGaq*, *diyaq* “to go out”, *alya* “I go out.” Unfortunately, the verbs “to take”, “to catch” or “to go out” are not attested in scarce Pumpokol mate-